Sound It Out

Stage Pre sample pack: four oral skills, free to try

Four oral skills that train your child's ear for the sounds inside words, before any letters appear. Word-for-word parent scripts are in lesson-guide.md.

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The practice words deliberately use the sounds m, s, a, t, p: the first five letters your child will meet in Stage 1.

No app. No account. No screens. Nothing collecting data about your child.

The full 25-skill curriculum, Stages Pre through 3, is available as a paid pack.

How to run a 10-minute session

Same shape every time

1. Warm up (1 minute): replay yesterday's game for a few turns.
2. Teach (2 minutes): read the script from the lesson guide, word for word.
3. Play (5 minutes): the cards or game for that skill.
4. Quick check (1 minute): a few solo turns, no help. Count quietly.
5. Stop while it is still fun.

When to move on: about 8 of 10 right, across two different days.**

When your child gets one wrong: model it again warmly and offer it again later.**
No penalty, no disappointment face.

The one habit that matters most: say pure sounds. Mmm, not muh. T, not tuh.**
Muh-ah-puh blends into muhahpuh, not map.

Rhyme Time cards

pa-01. Cut apart. Read the pair aloud; thumbs up if it rhymes.

cat / hat rhymes	**sun / fun** rhymes	**dog / log** rhymes
cat / dog does not rhyme	**sun / cup** does not rhyme	**pig / wig** rhymes
map / cap rhymes	**top / mop** rhymes	**mat / cup** does not rhyme
tap / dog does not rhyme	**sat / hat** rhymes	**pat / sun** does not rhyme

First Sounds cards

pa-02. Read the word; child says the FIRST SOUND, never the letter name.

mat starts with /m/	**sun** starts with /s/	**pig** starts with /p/
top starts with /t/	**apple** starts with /a/	**map** starts with /m/
sock starts with /s/	**pan** starts with /p/	**ten** starts with /t/
ant starts with /a/	**mop** starts with /m/	**sip** starts with /s/

Oral blending

pa-03. Say the broken sounds about a second apart; child says the whole word.

/m/ /a/ makes: ma	**/a/ /t/** makes: at	**/s/ /a/ /t/** makes: sat
/m/ /a/ /t/ makes: mat	**/t/ /a/ /p/** makes: tap	

More practice, same sounds: p ... a ... t (pat), m ... a ... p (map), s ... a ... p (sap).

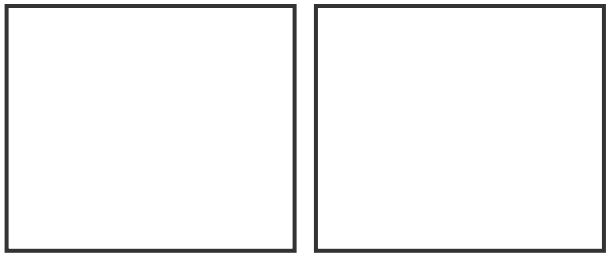
Keep the gap short at first; stretch it to a full second as your child improves.
Move on: about 8 of 10, across two different days.**

Sound boxes: segmenting

pa-04. Say the word; child pushes one counter per sound while saying it.

Words: at mat sat tap pat (then: map, sap, am)

Two-sound mat



Three-sound mat

Counters can be coins, buttons, or dry cereal.

Move on: 8 of 10 across two days. Then your child is ready for Stage 1 and first letters.**